



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

śrīdharaḥ :

citte śuddhe 'pi na dhyānaṃ vinā saṃnyāsa-mātrataḥ |

muktiḥ syād iti śaṣṭhe 'smin dhyāna-yogo vitanvate ||

— Bhagavadgītā-4comm with the commentaries of Śrīdhara, Madhusūdana, Viśvanātha and Baladeva, Chapter 1, Verse

1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

Śrīdhara's insightful verse sets the stage for a deeper understanding of the Bhagavad Gītā, particularly as we approach the crucial teachings on meditation in the sixth chapter. He gently reminds us that even a pure heart, achieved perhaps through righteous living and detachment, isn't enough to guarantee liberation. Simply renouncing worldly possessions or performing outward acts of piety, "saṃnyāsa-mātrataḥ," won't automatically unlock the doors to freedom. True liberation, or mukti, requires something more: the dedicated practice of meditation, "dhyāna-yogo."

This verse highlights a common misconception. Many of us believe that if we are good people, follow the rules, and perhaps even donate to charity, we are on the right path. While these actions are undoubtedly beneficial and contribute to a virtuous life, they are not the complete picture. Śrīdhara suggests that without the inner work of meditation, our efforts remain somewhat superficial. We might be cleaning the outside of the cup, so to speak, but neglecting to purify the contents within.

In our modern, fast-paced world, this message is particularly relevant. We are constantly bombarded with distractions, demands on our time, and pressures to achieve. It's easy to get caught up in the external world, striving for success and validation. But Śrīdhara's words encourage you to look inward. No matter how busy you are, no matter how many responsibilities you carry, you must dedicate time to quiet the mind and connect with your inner self. Meditation, in its various forms, becomes the essential tool for cultivating this inner peace and clarity. It's through this practice that you begin to truly understand yourself, transcend your limitations, and ultimately, move closer to liberation from suffering. The Gītā, through Krishna's teachings, will guide you towards this realization.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

How can you integrate even a few moments of mindful contemplation into your daily routine to cultivate inner stillness amidst the chaos of modern life?